relationship between desk analysts and field operatives. While field agents put their lives on the line, analysts filtered the information and corroborated it with different sources before sending it on to the top brass for further action.

Jindal, however, insisted that Clarke's loyalties were beyond doubt. So he called New Delhi in early December 1984, after the new government had settled in, and reminded his boss Anuj Bhardwaj about Clarke's warning against Khan and his cronies, including an Indian named B.N. Sandhu. Bhardwaj, known as the pop star of spies, had woke up late with a headache that cold winter morning and was feeling breathless. He listened to Jindal's coded complaint against the analysts and curtly told him to come to Delhi the next week for a one-on-one meeting.

At Bhardwaj's office, the two discussed high-grade intelligence sent to the agency before Indira Gandhi's assassination.

'Give me a quick rundown on your reports sent last year,' Bhardwaj demanded.

'I don't want to sound repetitive but you know our asset in London had warned that the ISI and Khan were plotting against India. It may have had nothing to do with the assassination of the prime minister, but I am worried about the increasing activities of these elements and if you check the reports, there is merit to his warnings,' Jindal said.

'It does make sense that Khan is working in collusion with Sandhu and the ISI and I am not ruling out their capability to subvert local politicians as well, but give me a solution and don't count your laurels,' said Bhardwaj harshly.